



VertiGO!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 706 December 2007 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Travers Traverse (Tony Gates)



Section Night 3 December 2007

Grant Piper in Antarctica. Come along and hear about Grant's adventures and wish all your fellow climbers Happy Xmas Climbing Adventures!



NB: First Section Night 4 February 2008

The first section night for 2008 will be held at Fergs. Admission will be free to Club members and there will also be a BBQ. We will need some help on the BBQ (free sausages) so please contact Blair on bh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz if you are keen to help out.



Section Trip News

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.



Centennial beckoned last week...

Eight members took part in a Wellington Section Southern Alps trip from 10-18 November, based out of Centennial Hut on the Franz Josef glacier.

As our helicopter crept up the sides of the glacier on Day One towards some fairly ominous clouds, some of us may have wondered what we were flying into. But we needn't have worried - we emerged into brilliant sunshine, highlighting the expansive snowfields and the exciting variety of peaks that surround the hut. The trip was suddenly looking very promising indeed.

Next morning we prepared for our first adventure: the Minarets (3040m). We were away well before first light for the 3km approach across the glacier, our crampons crunching satisfyingly in crisp snow. By dawn we had reached the foot of the slope which would lead us up onto a plateau separating the two Minarets from neighbouring De La Beche (2950m). Six soloed the slope, while two pitched it. This provided a valuable practical lesson in the amount of time that pitching uses up - an additional $\frac{3}{4}$ hour for three pitches.

A small snow plateau at the top of the slope provided a good spot to re-fuel before turning our attention to the Minarets. The ascent (up the northwest face) is fairly easy. From the summit (especially on a cloudless day) you gain a stunning panorama right across the vast Mount Cook region as well as various glaciers.

Some then proposed an ascent of De La Beche, given that we were so close. The "speedsters" of the group set off, sidling below the ridge and skirting a marked schrund before tackling the steep north face and then mixed snow and rock to the summit.

The next morning dawned fine again, and the more energetic of the party leapt out of bed to climb Aurora (2685m). As I was among the (majority of) group members who chose sleeping bag over mountain, all I can say is that they seemed from the hut balcony to be moving fast and well, nothing very technical required, and they were back at the hut about 4 hours after they left (perhaps earlier).

In retrospect, perhaps the rest of us should have forced ourselves out of bed after all, as that morning was the last of the good weather in the hills for us. By lunchtime the wind had increased, the cloud swirled in and the snow was on its way. For the next two days we all had more than enough time to hang around in our sleeping bags, hut-bound by a southerly front bringing 30cm of new snow. Plenty of time to swap tall stories and compare climbing gear!

Finally, two days later, the weather cleared and the helicopter returned. Despite our natural desire to stay on, the reality was that it would take at least two days for all the new snow to consolidate - more time than we had, and probably more time than the new weather window would allow. There was nothing for it but to pack and depart - and promise ourselves that we'd be back.

Thursday was wet again, necessitating sampling of the Fox café culture. But by Friday we were back outside, this time gearing up to play in the ice of the Franz Josef Glacier (and give the tourists a bit of a thrill).

Overall, despite the weather disappointments mid-week, it was a great trip spent with a lovely group of people. We got more done than we might have, and got to spend time in a pretty amazing part of the country. Thanks to all - and especially to Garth London for his organisation.

Cat Robinson

Trip Participants

Garth London, Robert Hawes, Craig Robinson, Catriona Robinson, Terry ("the Machine") Crippen, Glen Millar, Trey Guinn, Neville Palmer



It's not all about NZ mountains...

The glory without the sweat, blood or tears

Sick of lugging a huge pack crammed with heavy climbing gear? Finding freeze-dried food just a little tiresome? But you still want to climb a high peak? Drawing on a recent jaunt to the Pyrenees, here are ten tips for summiting a 3000 metre peak without the weight, desperation or substandard food.

- 1) Leave your climbing gear and ice tools in the cupboard.
- 2) Don't buy any packet food.
- 3) Pay a large amount of money to book a flight to Europe and feel lots of guilt about your contribution to climate change.
- 4) Turn up at the airport and check in your 10kg pack.
- 5) Get off in France and head for the hills to do a circuit criss-crossing the French-Spanish border, taking in the world famous Cirque de Gavarnie and Breche de Roland.
- 6) Eat local meals every night and buy gourmet cheese and fresh bread as you walk.
- 7) Meet and walk with language teachers fluent in English, French and Spanish so that you experience less confusion and misunderstandings.

- 8) Drink lots of cheap Spanish beer.
- 9) Climb Le Taillon, 3144 metres, bearing a day pack with next to nothing in it.
- 10) Savour the moment of being higher than Mt Aspiring, sweat-free and hardly puffing.

Lou Thornley



Possible new route on Hopeless 26-28 October 2007

Wellington section members Colin Cook, Marc Heatley, Helen Mitchell, Peter Shanahan and Ron Stutter, together with (yet to become section members) Stuart Hutson, Maree Roberts, Nigel Hubbard and Mark McDonald headed to Nelson Lakes National Park for an extended weekend.

The group planned to split up and head for Mt Hopeless, to complete a couloir and southwest ridge traverse (5), Mt Travers (2), and Mt Cupola (2).

After an outrageously late start, the Hopeless group had an eventful (some would say epic) day out when things didn't go quite according to plan. Crossing above the bluffs from Cupola Basin and ascending the couloir was straightforward but things became interesting when descending the SW ridge. They drifted away from the ridge out onto the western face and then once the SW ridge was regained they decided to start their descent somewhat earlier than the route guide would suggest.

The slopes became excessively steep and bluffs intervened. To cut a long story short, a total of seven abseils later the group was back on easy ground and heading back for a very late supper.

Ron Stutter



Girdlestone 17 November 2007

Wellington section members Colin Cook and Ron Stutter, with Stuart Hutson and Michael Buchanan, drove to Rangataua after work on Friday and set their alarm for 4.15am. The following morning, in excellent snow conditions and with a magnificent cloudless windless day they climbed the Mangaehuehu Face on Girdlestone before heading back to Wellington. After summiting, Colin and Michael made a "detour" to complete a Girdlestone-Tahurangi traverse on the way back down.

Ron Stutter



NATIONAL OFFICE REQUEST

NATIONAL OFFICE REQUEST - Old Annual Reports

As part of our ongoing sorting, it has come to light that our Hocken Archive Collection and National Reference Library are missing copies of our Annual Reports as follows:

Archive: Pre 1963, 64,65,66,68,69,78,79,83,87,89,93

Library: Pre 1998 (except 1981)

Please have a look to see if you have any old copies stashed away that you may be able to help us out with. They can be sent to Margaret at NZAC, PO Box456,Christchurch Mail Centre 8140

Thank you



DISCOUNTED PUBLICATIONS

NZAC will no longer be selling MSC36 Avalanche Accidents once our remaining stock of 13 is gone.

Be in to purchase a copy for the below cost price of only \$10 each, plus p&p.

Plus, don't forget our other special offer of the Taranaki or Wellington Rock guides \$15 each, or \$25 the pair, plus p&p



DISTAGHIL SAR AWARD

Thanks to all those who expressed an interest in receiving an award from the Distaghil Sar Fund. Awards are made to those who attend courses and then use from they have learnt to contribute towards the Section's instruction courses in Rock and Alpine. This year we say congratulations to Blair Hiscoke, the Co-ordinator of the Summer Rock programme and an Assistant Instructor on AIC, who received an award to attend a Rock Instruction Course in the Darrans with Paul Rogers. Well done, Blair.



NZAC BULLETIN – NO. 1

Recently discovered in an old NZAC Alpine Journal was an original of the NZAC's first Bulletin of 1946. While this will be sent to our Hocken Archives, a scanned copy is available for member's interest on our Library webpage 348. Quite a few other interesting bits and pieces of Club info has also been found in the same way. Should any of you come across any, please send it to Margaret at the National Office, so that it can be preserved in our Archive Collection.



CLIMBING CAMPS



Hopkins Climbing Camp 2008

Register before December 1, help the organisers and avoid a late fee!

Go on day climbs / scrambles / tramps / mountain bike rides or longer multi – day trips to some major climbing destinations like the Dasler Pinnacles, Mt Strauchan or Mt Ward

When? – 29 December 2007 - 6 January, 2008

Where? – Huxley Lodge, Hopkins River.

Costs? - \$40 for individuals plus accommodation.

What to do when you get there?

Check out the information pack on-line at www.alpineclub.org.nz

See you there!



Taranaki Climbing Camp

Early Bird Registration ends December 1

Good alpine rock offers fantastic trad climbing within a brief walk of the camp. Go tramping in the Goblin Forest or alpine trekking with technical difficulty being anything you desire.

The most spectacular backdrops ever encountered with views out to Ruapehu, the Kaikoura Ranges and the Tasman Sea.

When? – 18 -23 January

Where? – Manganui Lodge, East Taranaki

Costs? - \$15 for individuals plus accommodation.

What to do when you get there?

Check out the information pack on-line at www.alpineclub.org.nz

See you there!



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AND HERE ARE THE CLUB TRIPS

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, send an email to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

Trips for the Calendar so far...

29Dec07 – 6Jan08 – Annual National NZAC Climbing Camp – Hopkins Valley

South Canterbury – Based at Huxley Lodge at the head of Lake Ohau – next major valley south of Mt Cook NP. This is a an excellent opportunity to “buddy-up” with other aspiring climbers at a marvellous location. Good access to several major snow and rock peaks including Mt Ward, Mt Jackson, Glen Isla and of course the Daisler Pinnacles (recently featured in Climber). For the information pack pdf (23KB) [click here](#). For further information including registration see the National NZAC website for details - <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=358>. Contact Kevin kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for car pooling arrangements from Wellington.

18-23Jan08 – NZAC North Island Rock Climbing Camp – Mt Egmont (Taranaki).

Based at Stratford Mountain Lodge (1300m) 20 minutes walk from the road end. Good alpine rock offers fantastic trad climbing within a short walk of the lodge. For the information pack pdf (23KB) [click here](#). Be in quick, only 33 places available! For further information including registration see the National NZAC website for details - <http://www.alpineclub.org.nz/default.aspx?p=362>. Contact Kevin kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for car pooling arrangements from Wellington.

8-10Feb08 – Taranaki Rock – Leader = James Wright

Weekend trip to climb the rock on Mt Taranaki. Most likely we will be based from Tahurangi lodge on the Northern Slopes. Multiple rock routes on various pillars and outcrops including Humphries Castle. Contact James Wright at james.wright@extra.co.nz or call at (04) 232-7748 or (027) 4725-561.

21-30Mar08 – Copland Valley – Leader = Don French

Easter Trip – lead by “The Master”. There are plenty of mountaineering objectives off the Copland valley. Easter is early this year. Hope to have a fairly large group heading up the easy access from the westcoast. Numerous objectives prevail, including Mt Sefton (3151m) via Scotts creek and the Douglas Neve. There are a number of alternative objectives (e.g. Lyttle Peak – 2240m) for those not so keen on Sefton's lofty heights. There is only one rule: “No summit, no Hot Pools”! Tramping options include the Copland Pass and the Baker Saddle circuit. Contact Don at 027 445 2980 or 06 377 7117 or by email at df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.

24-28Apr08 – Mt Murchison (2408m) - ANZAC weekend trip – Leader = Don French

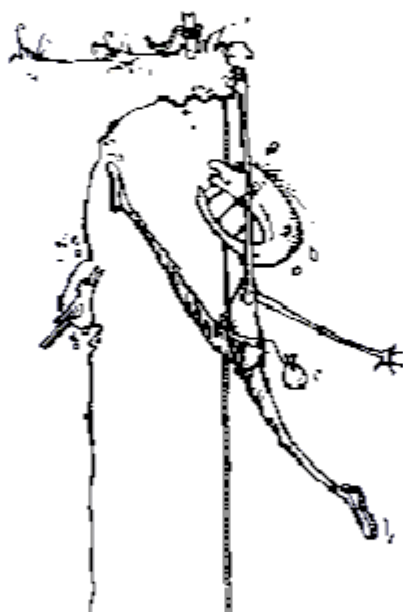
Highest peak in Arthurs Pass NP. Route in will be up the Waimakariri River via Carrington Hut, then the White River to arrive at Barkers Hut at the base of the White Glacier. Ideal for those who have recently completed the AIC. Contact Don at 027 445 2980 or 06 377 7117 or by email at df@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Wellington Section Directory: 2007 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Garth London	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Vice Chairperson	Jennifer Brown	JB2	027 292 0903
Secretary	Rachel Depree	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RD	N/A
Treasurer	Karen Domaneschi	TREASURER <i>or</i> KD	N/A
National Representative	Jennifer Brown and James Wright	JB2 <i>or</i> JW	N/A
	Garth London and Judy Reid	GL <i>or</i> JR	(04) 479 2984 (Garth)
Instruction: AIC	Rachael Schmidt	RS <i>or</i> AIC	N/A
Instruction: RIC	Blair Hiscoke	SPRINGROCK	N/A
National Instruction Rep	Rachael Schmidt	RS	N/A
Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	KF	N/A
Trips	Kevin Patterson	TRIPS <i>or</i> KP	N/A
	Gwen Rashbrooke	TRIPS <i>or</i> GR	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	N/A
Committee Members	Hayden Cox	HC	N/A
	Paul Grimwood	PG	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PD	N/A
	Blair Hiscoke	BH	N/A
	Louise Thornley	LT	N/A
	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
	Catherine Moger	CM2	N/A
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> RS	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Phil Doole		N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



If undelivered please return to:

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